

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Build credibility before bureaucracy.

Learn the real transaction, make priorities explicit, prove one useful mechanism, and institutionalize only what the evidence supports. The plan assumes executive sponsorship, access to process owners, and a bounded pilot opportunity; all specifics require internal discovery.

DAYS 0–30 · LEARN THE TRANSACTION

Stakeholders	Listen across Sales, Sales Operations, Finance, Operations, PMO, IT/systems, fulfillment, billing, support, and frontline roles. Capture goals, pain, incentives, active commitments, and decision friction.	Stakeholder map; operating tensions; sponsor and process-owner hypotheses.
O2C system	Map the customer promise through quote, order, fulfillment, acceptance, billing, revenue treatment, payment, support, and exception resolution. Trace Salesforce, NetSuite, ServiceNow, interfaces, and manual work only as verified.	Current-state transaction map; ownership and decision-rights gaps; exception inventory.
Performance	Reconcile definitions, sources, owners, and confidence for order accuracy, invoice quality, cycle time, unbilled inventory, and margin performance.	KPI definition register; baseline confidence; data gaps and near-term instrumentation.
Change load	Inventory active initiatives, system changes, offering launches, training demands, and dependency risk.	Change-capacity view; sequencing risks; candidate pilot shortlist.

DAYS 31–60 · MAKE PRIORITIES AND AUTHORITY EXPLICIT

OPE charter	Define the function's purpose, scope, decision interfaces, escalation role, engagement model, and ownership-transfer expectations.	OPE charter; governance cadence; RACI / decision-rights draft.
Portfolio	Score opportunities against outcome value, customer impact, margin/working-capital exposure, root-cause confidence, feasibility, change burden, and reuse.	Prioritized O2C roadmap; business-case standard; explicit defer/stop decisions.
Readiness	Co-design minimum evidence for commercial definition, margin logic, transaction path, finance treatment, system configuration, and operating adoption.	Airlock v1; release postures; exception and control requirements.
Pilot	Select one bounded offering or process issue with a named owner, measurable baseline, feasible change window, and executive sponsor.	Pilot contract; outcome, guardrails, plan, roles, evidence, and stop conditions.

DAYS 61–90 · PROVE ONE MECHANISM

Redesign	Address the highest-leverage root cause across definition, handoff, decision latency, configuration, control, or role design. Avoid automating ambiguity.	Future-state path; risk/control changes; configuration and SOP requirements.
Airlock pilot	Run the selected offering or change through the readiness gates. Record evidence, unresolved dependencies, controls, owners, and release decision.	Decision record: Ready, Ready with controls, or Hold; issue-resolution log.
Adoption	Build role-based SOPs, training, coaching, escalation, and reinforcement with the people who will operate the process.	Training package; proficiency check; support model; adoption signals.
Measurement	Track outcome, flow, quality, economics, exceptions, control performance, and behavior change against the baseline.	Pilot scorecard; weekly learning review; evidence for scale/revise/stop.

DAYS 91–120 · INSTITUTIONALIZE LEARNING

Decision	Review pilot evidence with business, Finance, IT, and operating owners. Decide scale, revise, contain, or stop. Capture what changed the decision.	Executive decision record; value and risk readout; reusable lessons.
Operating model	Finalize OPE governance, KPI cadence, portfolio review, change-control interface, readiness ownership, and exception policy.	OPE operating handbook; cadence calendar; escalation and ownership model.
Team	Define team roles and capability needs; establish coaching for process owners and CI practitioners; clarify specialist partnerships.	Team design; capability matrix; development and hiring priorities.
Roadmap	Sequence the next O2C portfolio based on evidence, economics, dependencies, and organizational change capacity.	12-month roadmap; investment asks; KPI targets only after baseline validation.

GUARDRAILS ACROSS ALL 120 DAYS

No invented certainty

Separate verified fact, current hypothesis, assumption, and open question in every decision artifact.

No parallel bureaucracy

OPE owns the mechanism and challenge process; business leaders retain outcome and operating ownership.

No metric without action

Every KPI needs a definition, owner, review cadence, threshold, and expected decision.

No launch without adoption

Configuration, SOPs, training, support, controls, and escalation are part of readiness—not post-launch cleanup.

DAY-120 EXECUTIVE READOUT

What we learned about the O2C system · What one pilot changed · What value and risk evidence says · What remains unresolved · What the readiness gate should govern · What the next portfolio should prioritize · What sponsorship and investment the function needs